



BRAND GUIDELINES

Version 1.3 · August 2026

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We are not a booking platform. We are the authority.

African Safari Group exists to make the most consequential journey our clients will ever book feel inevitable, considered, and flawlessly executed — and every page they read should carry that same quiet confidence.

01

Authority

Deep, reserve-level expertise. We know which lodge, which season, which guide — and say so plainly.

02

Craft

Every detail considered. Nothing default, nothing templated, nothing left to a stock theme.

03

Restraint

Confidence does not shout. Space, silence and precision do more than ornament ever could.

04

Trust

Consultation-led, never transactional. The brand should feel like a person, not a funnel.

The Mark

Our crest — a single, abstracted lion mane rendered as radiating lines — is fixed. It is never redrawn, recoloured outside this system, or replaced. Two lockups cover every use case.



STACKED

Square formats, social avatars, covers



HORIZONTAL

Website headers, email headers, wide formats — the preferred lockup for site navigation

Clear Space & Minimum Size

Maintain clear space equal to the height of the lion mark (x) on every side, for both lockups. No text or competing graphic may enter this zone.

Minimum Size

32px digital

15mm print

20px digital

10mm print (icon alone)

Always export at 2x for digital and vector (SVG/EPS) for print.



STACKED — CLEAR SPACE



HORIZONTAL — CLEAR SPACE

Approved Variations



Icon-Only Mark

Used alone — favicon, app icon, social avatar — where the brand is already established by context.



Never

- Recolour the mark outside Ink, Ivory, Brass, Heritage Sand or White
- Place it on a busy photograph without a dark scrim behind it
- Stretch, skew, rotate, or add shadows / bevels / outlines
- Reproduce the stacked lockup below 32px — use the icon alone

One Mark, Many Domains

Reserve sites, PPC properties and direct-booking platforms keep the same icon, the same serif setting and the same rule-line treatment as the master lockup. Only the name beneath the icon changes, to match the domain — this is the only approved way to create a new lockup.



AFRICAN SAFARI

GROUP



SABI SAND GAME

RESERVE



AMAKHALA

GAME RESERVE



SAFARIBOOKNOW

DIRECT BOOKING

Every sub-brand carries a small “Part of African Safari Group” endorsement line in its footer — the CMS included.

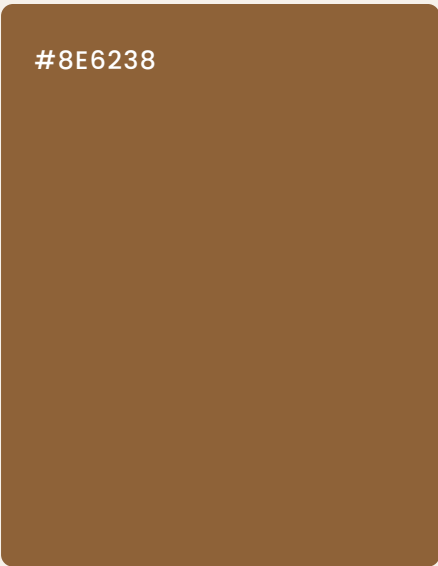
A Darker, Richer System

We are retiring the green / gold / grey set inherited from template defaults, in favour of one deep, near-black ground and a single refined brass accent — used the way a lodge uses brass fittings: with restraint.

#171411	#2B2622	#4A443C	#A8794B	#C39F77	#F6F1EA	#B9AFA2
ASG Ink	Charcoal	Soft Charcoal	Safari Brass	Heritage Sand	Warm Ivory	Bone
Primary ground — heroes, headers, footers.	Dark UI elements, secondary dark ground.	Body copy on light backgrounds — easier long-form reading.	Primary accent — CTAs, links, used sparingly.	Legacy tone — tints & secondary accents only.	Light ground — editorial pages, email backgrounds.	Borders & dividers on light ground.

Extended System & Retired Tones

Beyond the seven core tones, the system carries a small set of derived values — and one retirement. Every value here also lives in design-tokens.json.



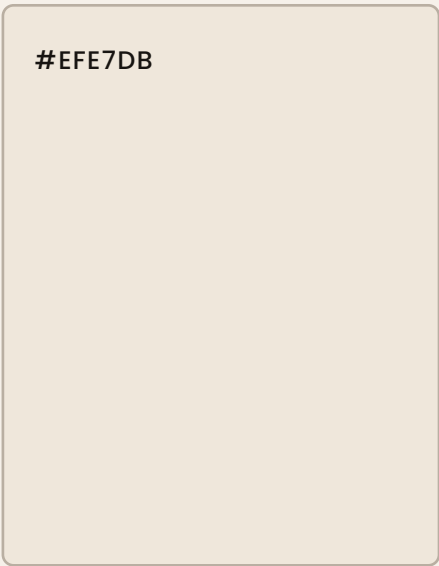
Deep Brass

Press/active state; the sub-12px solid-fill exception.



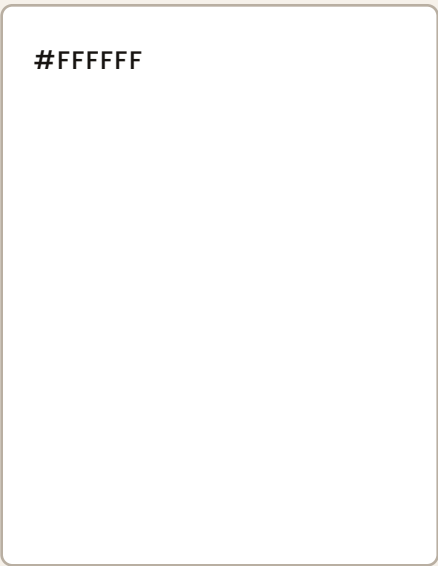
Badge Green

Status + savings — 'Most drives', 'Included', SAVE chips. White text.



Ivory Dim

Secondary light surface, hairlines on ivory.



White

Raised light surface; text on brass / green / ink.

RETIRED



#C8A96E Pale gold

Retired 13 Aug 2026 with Option 3. Never used, any surface, any size. Its dark-text rule died with it.

- No new accent colours, ever — Safari Brass is the only accent.
- Feedback tones stay warm and muted, never neon.
- One colour system across brand book, web and email.

Contrast Rules

Hard-won and non-negotiable. These preserve legibility and keep the brass reading as a fitting, not a flood.

- **Brass takes white text — always.**
In both themes. No exceptions.
- **Sub-12px brass fills step to Deep Brass #8E6238.**
The fill adapts to hold white-text contrast; the text stays white.
- **Hover lighter, press darker.**
Brass-400 on hover, Brass-600 on press. No shrink on press.
- **Sand & pale tones take dark/ink text.**
Never white on Heritage Sand at small sizes.
- **Links on light grounds use Deep Brass.**
Base brass is too weak on ivory for a link.
- **Muted #A89D8C-family is never body text on light.**
Decorative captions only; body uses #7A7166 or stronger.

APPROVED PAIRINGS

Aa Brass	White text
Aa Deep Brass	White (sub-12px) text
Aa Badge Green	White text
Aa Heritage Sand	Ink text
Aa Ink	Warm Ivory text
Aa Warm Ivory	Soft Charcoal text

Use Brass Like Brass Fittings

If brass is everywhere it reads as cheap gold rather than a refined accent. This ratio governs every layout — website, email, slide or brochure.



Ink / Charcoal — 60%

Dominant ground: nav, headers, backgrounds, body copy.

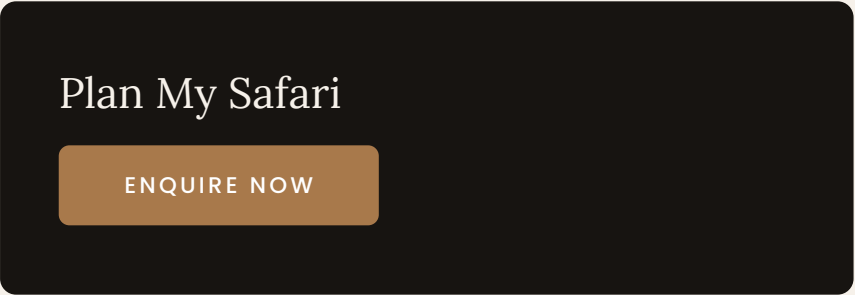
Ivory / White — 30%

Breathing room: editorial sections, cards, negative space.

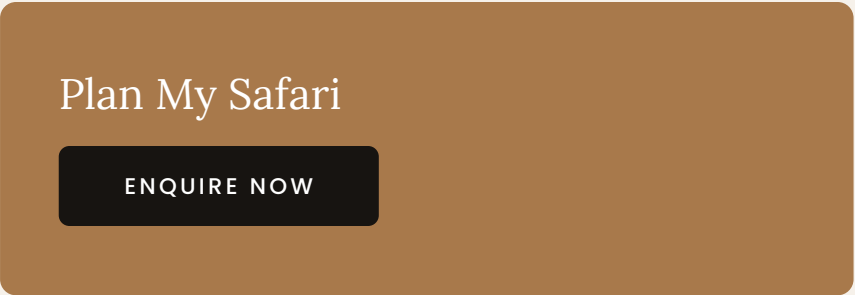
Brass — 10%

Signal only: primary CTA, key numerals, active states, dividers.

In Practice



Correct — one brass call-to-action against ink.



Incorrect — brass as a dominant ground reads dated.

Lora & Poppins

We are retiring Roboto / Barlow. Lora is a refined serif that echoes the warmth of the wordmark for headlines; Poppins is a clean geometric sans for body copy, navigation and UI.

Aa

Lora — Display & Headlines
H1/H2, pull quotes, lodge & destination names

Aa

Poppins — Body & UI
Body copy, navigation, buttons, forms, captions

H1Your Africa, Considered.

EYEBROWBIG FIVE · MALARIA-FREE

BODYBest price guarantee on contracted rates, with no booking fees.

CAPTIONFrom R 14,500 pp / night · 5 lodges available

How the Hierarchy Behaves

- **Headlines stay short.**

Six to nine words. If it needs more, it's body copy, not a headline.

- **Never set Poppins in all-caps below 9pt.**

Tracked caps work for eyebrows and labels — not body text.

- **One serif moment per screen.**

A single Lora headline or pull quote per view keeps it editorial.

- **Line length: 60–75 characters.**

Body copy never spans the full width of a layout.

- **Numerals are always Poppins.**

Prices, dates and stats stay Poppins-Medium, even inside serif paragraphs.

- **The PriceCard From-price is the one exception.**

A lodge page's hero From-price may set its numeral in Lora — the system's sole serif-numeral moment. Nowhere else.

Authoritative, Warm, Never Salesy.

We write like the specialist a client is grateful to have found — confident because we know the reserves personally, warm because this is the trip of their life, restrained because real authority never needs to shout.

- Specific beats superlative — name the lodge, the season, the sighting odds, not “unforgettable.”
- Declarative sentences. Confidence reads in short, certain statements.
- No exclamation points. No emoji. Calm confidence outperforms enthusiasm.
- Speak as “we”, not in the third person, in client-facing copy.
- Lead with what the guest will experience, then support it with our expertise.

Instead of...

“Experience the adventure of a lifetime on this dream safari!”

Write...

“Sabi Sand offers the highest leopard-sighting density in Africa. Three nights gives you the best odds.”

Words & Formats

The voice made operational — the words we never use, the claims we may, and the formats that stay fixed everywhere ASG writes.

NEVER, GUEST-FACING

- ✗ cross-sell · upsell · any sales-mechanics jargon
- ✗ dream · unforgettable · incredible · amazing
- ✗ adventure of a lifetime
- ✗ book direct · the lodge's own rate · no markup
- ✗ exclamation points · emoji

RATE CLAIMS — ONLY THESE

- ✓ best price guarantee
- ✓ contracted rates
- ✓ no booking fees

FIXED FORMATS

Cross-promotion label

“More of the Reserve” (e.g. “Other lodges in Amakhala”). Fixed.

Temperatures

Dual-unit, Celsius first: 8–22 °C (46–72 °F). Panels and running copy alike.

Sightings

Plain probability — “Leopard — Rarely · elusive”. Never promise a sighting.

Prices in Rand

R 14,500 — space after R, thousands comma. Numerals always Poppins.

-
- ✗ “Experience the adventure of a lifetime on this dream safari!”
 - ✓ “Sabi Sand has the highest leopard-sighting density in Africa. Three nights gives you the best odds.”

Cinematic. Restrained.

Never a Stock Grid.

Photography carries more of this brand than any single design element. It should feel closer to Aman or Singita than a generic OTA carousel — vast landscapes, deliberate light, one clear subject, room to breathe.

SEEK

- + Golden hour & dramatic natural light
- + One clear subject — animal, lodge, or guest moment
- + Wide environmental shots with real negative space
- + Authentic guest moments, genuine emotion
- + Consistent warm, slightly desaturated grade

AVOID

- Bright, flat midday lighting
- Crowded collage / grid layouts of many small images
- Visible stock-site watermarks or generic agency stock
- Oversaturated neon-green grass or orange HDR
- Text crammed on top of busy image detail

SOURCING

All production photography comes from ASG's Pimcore infrastructure (pim.africansafarigroup.com, amakhala.com). The brand book carries no photography; real imagery must be supplied to finish any kit or page.

Web Hero

AFRICAN SAFARI
GROUP

DESTINATIONSEXPERIENCESACCOMMODATIONABOUT

Your Africa, Considered.

Tailor-made five-star safaris across Southern & East Africa, designed by specialists who have stayed at every lodge they recommend.

PLAN MY SAFARI

Email & Social



Your Sabi Sand Itinerary

Hi Sarah — based on our call, I've shortlisted three lodges for your October dates.

Londolozi Founders Camp

From R 18,200 pp / night

VIEW ITINERARY



LEOPARD CAPITAL

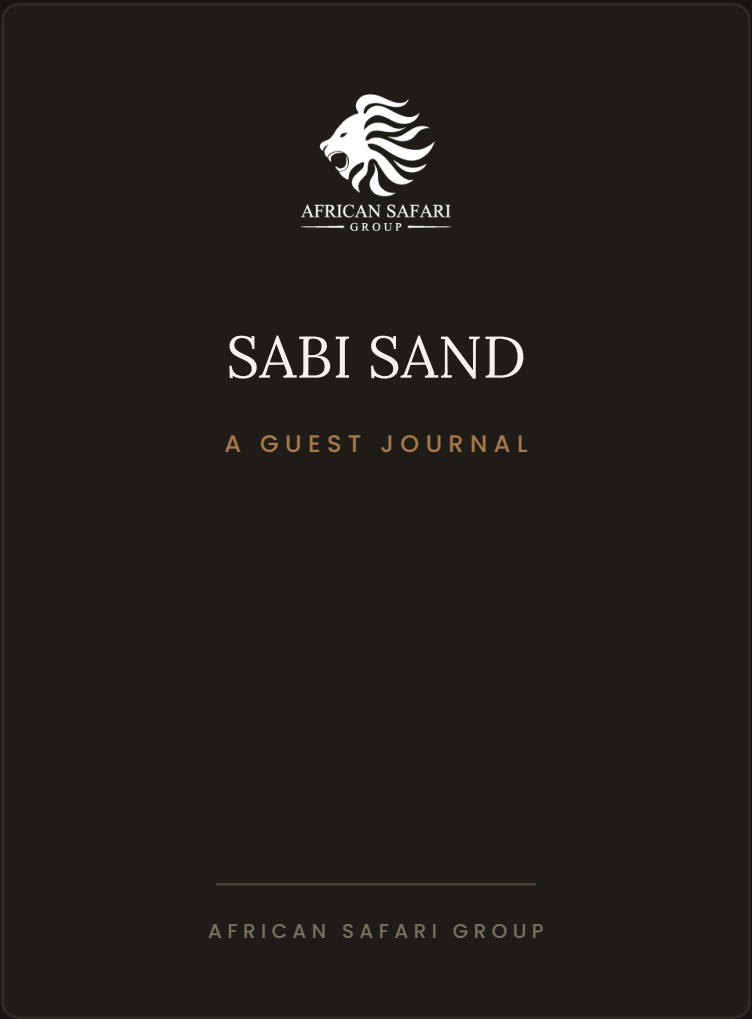
OF AFRICA

@africansafarigroup

Brochure & Stationery



Business Card



Brochure Cover

Print follows the same rules as digital: ink ground, one brass signal, generous margins, and the mark exactly as specified.

Any designer — internal or external — should be able to build a correct piece from this book and the /themes/ package, without needing to ask what's allowed.

Components — Hero & Signal

Option 4 · Ink Edition ships seven web patterns. Each lives in the design-system export with a card, JSX, a types contract and a usage prompt. Four of them here.

FACTPILL

Frosted hero stat badges — never bare text on photos.

✦BIG FIVE

✦MALARIA-FREE

✦4 LODGES

SIGHTINGSBADGE

Honest probability levels — never a promise.

MOST DRIVES

VERY OFTEN

OFTEN

RARELY

MONTHGRID

Peak = brass+white · Good = sand+ink · Fair = bone+ink.

J

F

M

A

M

J

J

A

S

O

N

D

VALUEPROPBAR

CURRENT SPECIALS

BEST PRICE

PLAN WITH A CONSULTANT

EXPERT SUPPORT

Components — Booking & Proof

The remaining core patterns, plus the two page behaviours the CMS depends on.

PRICECARD

FROM

R 14,500 pp / night

PLAN WITH A CONSULTANT

No payment taken online.

Hero booking sidebar. The From-price is the one serif-numeral exception.

ENQUIRYCHECKLIST

- ✓ Best price guarantee on contracted rates
- ✓ No booking fees, ever
- ✓ A specialist who has stayed at the lodge

The why-enquire-direct panel — brass check circles.

ACCREDITATIONROW

SATSA MEMBER 3099

ATTA

CAPE TOWN TOURISM

TRIPADVISOR

BEHAVIOURS

Nav handoff

Main nav is sticky until the sub-nav meets it, then slides away (0.28s) and the sub-nav owns the top. Reverses on scroll-up; hidden on cold deep-link load.

Scrollspy

A brass underline follows the section in view. Bare href="#" links are excluded so the querySelector never throws.

Breadcrumbs

Top-left of the hero, no background. Links in Sand with brass hover; the current page is plain text, never a link.

Specials, Gallery & FAQ

Three patterns unique to the lodge template — and the schema rule the CMS must honour.

SAVECHIP



Solid Badge Green, white text (hero price card, card headers) — OR a green top-rule with a ~5% tint wash on cells. Nothing else. In-cell links on the special cell use soft green #9FBFA3, not brass.

LIGHTBOX



Exactly five tiles (one tall + four), overlay on the fifth. Ink scrim .94, brass circular prev/next, counter, Esc / arrows / scrim-close, scroll lock. Room photos are a separate set via a corner badge — never a full scrim over the room image.

FAQ ACCORDION

Is the reserve malaria-free?

+

How many nights do you recommend?

+

Good to Know + FAQ are required on every lodge page. Answers are unique per page — zero identical strings across pages, verified programmatically. FAQPage JSON-LD in the head is mandatory; the CMS auto-generates it from the FAQ content.

The Lodge Page — Anatomy

Every lodge page is built on one frozen template. The order and the counts are canon.

Hero	Ink, bottom-up scrim · breadcrumbs top-left · one serif headline · PriceCard in the hero
Value-prop bar	Four cells, fixed order: Current Specials › Best Price › Plan With a Consultant › Expert Support
Overview + Gallery	Exactly five tiles (one tall + four), 'View all' overlay on the fifth · ink-scrim lightbox
Rooms	Two-column grid, one column below 1000px · each card binds its own hero image + photo set
Good to Know + FAQ	Policies + specials conditions · 12 unique GEO FAQs + FAQPage JSON-LD
More of the Reserve	Sister-lodge cross-promotion — the fixed label; never 'cross-sell'
Footer	Accreditation row + 'Part of African Safari Group' endorsement line

The Lodge Page — Rules

The non-negotiables that keep the template honest, legal, and on-brand in production.

- **Rate-claim hygiene**

Only 'best price guarantee', 'contracted rates', 'no booking fees'. Any other assurance is removed unless T&Cs back it and it carries a footnote. ASG sells under STO agreements and is not the lodge.

- **Prices are always bound**

Pimcore holds ZAR base rates; the site converts at render by visitor IP. Mockup prices are placeholder snapshots — the price field is never hardcoded in production.

- **No feedback widget on guest-facing deploys**

The Replit feedback widget and 'Made with Replit' badge stay OFF (Publishing › Engagement tools). Checked on every republish.

- **Pull-quotes are never fabricated**

Each lodge's interlude quote comes from the lodge's own copy — never an invented guest quote.

- **Image hosts**

pim.africansafarigroup.com / amakhala.com only. Judge imagery in a real browser — sandboxed previews block external requests.

Decisions of Record

Settled. Not open for reinterpretation per project. The machine-readable mirror is design-tokens.json.

13 Aug 2026	Option 4 (CMS × Ink) is the official ASG web/CMS system. All other options retired.
13 Aug 2026	Pale gold #C8A96E retired with Option 3 — its dark-text contrast rule retired with it.
13 Aug 2026	Banned rate claims: never 'book direct', 'the lodge's own rate', 'no markup'.
Aug 2026	Brass small-fill exception: solid brass fills under 12px step the fill to Deep Brass #8E6238.
Aug 2026	Badge Green #4F6B51 role extended from sightings/inclusion to savings signals (SAVE chips).
Standing	No new accent colours, ever. Safari Brass is the only accent.
Standing	Canonical brand book is v1.3; every export stamps 'Reflects ASG Brand Guidelines v1.3'.

The Pointer Package

What to hand any designer, developer, agency or printer briefed on ASG work. If it isn't in these, it isn't on-brand.

This brand book ASG_Brand_Guidelines_v1.3.pdf — the why and the rules, in human form.	THEME-SPEC.md The single pointer spec — colour, type, voice, components, application by surface.	design-tokens.json Machine-readable — hexes, CSS vars, scales, themes, component values, email/print maps.
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Consumption: web projects link the export's compiled styles.css and read tokens as CSS variables; email and print consume raw values from design-tokens.json. When this book and a downstream file disagree, the book and the /themes/ package win — and the downstream file gets fixed.

Custodian: Riaan Aggenbag, CEO · github.com/riaan-aggenbag/asg-brand-guidelines



AFRICAN SAFARI
GROUP

AFRICAN SAFARI GROUP

Brand custodian: Riaan Aggenbag, CEO

Brand questions or asset requests: bookings@africansafarigroup.com

VERSION HISTORY

v1.0 · 2026

Initial Ink Edition — 17 pages.

v1.1 / v1.2 · Aug 2026

Soft Charcoal body tone; crest crop fixed; canonical.

v1.3 · August 2026

Option 4 formalised; extended colour, contrast, voice and the Web & CMS system folded in; pale gold retired.

Reflects design-tokens.json + THEME-SPEC.md · /themes/ package

ASG-BOOK-V13-20260816-R1